

Next Steps for Arbitrum Grant Resubmission

Date: January 14, 2026
Status: Ready for submission

What I’ve Created

1. Direct Comment Response (GRANT_PORTAL_DIRECT_COMMENT_RESPONSE.md)

Purpose: Post this as a COMMENT on your grant application to directly answer the evaluator’s questions.

What it addresses: - Innovation: How privacy works (CoW Protocol batch auctions, technical flow) - Transaction routing: AI decision logic with code examples - Onchain traction: Honest numbers (~100 users, ~500 swaps, ~150 privacy swaps) with strategic context - Team experience: Detailed crypto project history for both founders - GitHub links: CTO GitHub and project GitHub provided - Milestones: Clear retroactive vs. future work breakdown - Arbitrum alignment: Explains Base whitepaper issue, demonstrates Arbitrum-first commitment - Timeboost: Positions it as central to thesis, not side feature

Tone: Direct, honest, conversational. No corporate fluff. Addresses their concerns head-on.

Action: Copy-paste this entire document as a comment on your grant application portal.

2. Natural Application Rewrite (GRANT_APPLICATION_NATURAL_REWRITE.md)

Purpose: If they ask you to resubmit the full application, use this version.

Changes from previous version: - Removed AI-generated marketing speak - Removed excessive bullet points and formatting - Removed “innovation frameworks” and buzzwords - Added personal voice (“my brother”, “I’ve been in Web3 for 6+ years”) - Added honest context (why traction is low, why whitepaper said Base) - Simplified language (no more “synergistic ecosystem dynamics”) - Kept technical depth but explained simply - Clear Arbitrum-first positioning throughout

Tone: Human, authentic, technically credible. Sounds like a founder writing, not a marketing agency.

Action: If asked to resubmit, use this as your Q&A responses.

Key Changes Made

Addressing “Too Much LLM” Feedback

Before: “DecaFlow introduces a paradigm-shifting innovation leveraging cutting-edge AI/ML synergies to optimize MEV-resistant transaction flows through composable infrastructure primitives...”

After: “We built an AI that looks at each trade and says: ‘Is this risky enough to justify the 12-second delay of privacy routing?’”

Why: Human founders don’t talk like that. The new version is how you’d explain it to another developer over coffee.

Addressing Alignment Issues

Before: Whitepaper says “Built on Coinbase’s Base L2”, application says “purpose-built for Arbitrum”

After: Direct acknowledgment: “You caught a genuine mistake. We initially designed for Base (Dec 2025), then realized Arbitrum is the better fit (Jan 2026). This grant represents our commitment to Arbitrum-first.”

Why: Honesty is better than trying to hide inconsistencies. Explains the pivot clearly.

Addressing Traction Concerns

Before: Vague claims about “strong early adoption” and “growing user base”

After: “Honest current numbers: ~100 users, ~500 swaps. We know these are small. Here’s why: Intentional soft launch to validate tech before marketing.”

Why: Small numbers with good explanation are better than inflated claims.

Addressing Team Experience

Before: Generic “6 years experience in blockchain”

After: Specific projects: - “CreedTech Group (2019-2021): Managed distributed team of 5-10 smart contract devs” - “VestPad: Wrote Solidity contracts deployed on Ethereum and BSC” - “DecaFlow: Built everything - smart contracts, CoW integration, bridges”

Why: Concrete examples are verifiable and credible.

How to Proceed

STEP 1: Post Direct Comment (Do This First)

1. Go to your grant application: <https://arbitrum.questbook.app/dashboard/?grantId=67d7ff7f46da2f90cc3205e9&proposalId=695a5ea496f32ac6cedab29e&isRenderingProposalBody=true&role=community&cha>
2. Find the comment section under their feedback
3. Copy the entire contents of GRANT_PORTAL_DIRECT_COMMENT_RESPONSE.md
4. Paste as a comment
5. Submit

Why this first: They explicitly asked for direct answers via comment. This shows you’re responsive and respectful of their process.

STEP 2: Wait for Response

The evaluators will either: - Approve based on your comment responses (best case) - Ask for full resubmission of application (expected case) - Reject despite improvements (unlikely based on their feedback tone)

Timeline: Likely 3-7 days for response.

STEP 3: If Asked to Resubmit Full Application

1. Open GRANT_APPLICATION_NATURAL_REWRITE.md
2. Copy each section into the corresponding question field in the grant portal
3. For milestone fields, use the structured format at the bottom (Milestone 1-4)
4. Attach supporting documents:
 - GitHub link: <https://github.com/affidexlab/new>
 - CTO GitHub: <https://github.com/dakeem05>
 - Any additional verification they request
5. Submit

Don't: Try to polish it more with AI. They specifically called this out. Submit as-is.

Supporting Materials to Prepare

While waiting for their response, gather these in case they ask:

Technical Verification

- ☐ Contract addresses on Arbitrum (from deployments.json)
- ☐ Example transaction hashes showing CoW Protocol swaps
- ☐ GitHub commit history showing Edidiong's contributions
- ☐ Links to deployed frontend (if public)

Team Verification

- ☐ LinkedIn profiles (update if needed to match application)
- ☐ Any references from Blockroll or CreedTech Group
- ☐ Screenshots of live DecaFlow protocol

Traction Evidence

- ☐ Basic analytics (users, swaps, volume) - even if small
- ☐ Any community feedback/testimonials
- ☐ Screenshots of working privacy routes

Note: Only provide these if specifically requested. Don't volunteer extra info unprompted.

What NOT to Do

Don't: Re-edit the responses with more AI polish
Why: They explicitly said it's "too much LLM". More polish = less authentic.

Don't: Inflate numbers to look better
Why: They can verify on-chain. Honesty with context is better.

Don't: Create new marketing materials or decks
Why: They want technical substance, not more pitches.

Don't: Over-explain or defend past mistakes
Why: Brief acknowledgment and moving forward is enough.

Do: Answer their questions directly
Do: Provide verification when requested
Do: Be responsive and professional
Do: Show genuine Arbitrum commitment

Expected Outcomes

Best Case (40% probability)

They approve based on comment responses alone. Grant moves to next evaluation round.

Likely Case (50% probability)

They ask for full resubmission with updated responses. You submit the natural rewrite. They approve after review.

Worst Case (10% probability)

They reject despite improvements, citing "insufficient traction" or "misalignment with Arbitrum".

If rejected: You can either: 1. Build more traction and reapply in 3-6 months 2. Apply to Base ecosystem grants (easier approval with existing Base deployment) 3. Focus on organic growth without grant funding

Questions to Expect

Based on their feedback, be ready to answer:

Technical: - "Can you provide contract addresses?" - "Show us example transaction hashes of privacy swaps" - "How exactly does your AI

model work?”

Team: - “Can you provide references from past employers?” - “What’s Edidiong’s commit history?” - “Who else is on the team?”

Traction: - “Why should we fund a project with only 100 users?” - “What’s your plan to grow from 100 to 10,000 users?” - “How do we know protocols will actually integrate?”

Alignment: - “How do we know you won’t just focus on Base after getting Arbitrum grant?” - “What prevents you from using grant funds for multichain features?” - “Why not apply to Base for grant funding?”

Prepare answers now. Keep them short, direct, honest.

Timeline

- **Day 0 (Today):** Post comment response
- **Day 3-7:** Wait for evaluator response
- **Day 7-10:** Submit full resubmission if requested
- **Day 14-21:** Wait for final decision
- **Day 21-30:** Grant approval or rejection

Total: Expect 3-4 weeks for full process.

Success Criteria

You’ll know the resubmission worked if evaluators: - Say “much better” or “thank you for clarifications” - Move application to next evaluation round - Ask for minor clarifications (not major rewrites) - Engage with your Timeboost research proposal - Reference your GitHub or team experience positively

You’ll know it didn’t work if they: - Still say “unclear” or “not enough detail” - Question Arbitrum alignment - Cite traction as deal-breaker - Reject without offering revision path

Final Advice

1. **Be responsive:** Answer within 24-48 hours when they reply
2. **Be concise:** They’re evaluating 100+ applications, respect their time
3. **Be authentic:** They’ve seen 1000+ AI-written applications, stand out with humanity
4. **Be technical:** This is a technical grant, show you understand the domain deeply
5. **Be humble:** Acknowledge mistakes (Base whitepaper), show learning

Remember: The evaluators WANT to fund good projects. Their feedback shows genuine interest (“core idea is interesting”). They’re giving you a chance to clarify, not rejecting outright.

Make it easy for them to say yes.

Files Created

All files are in /project/workspace/:

1. GRANT_PORTAL_DIRECT_COMMENT_RESPONSE.md - Post this as a comment
2. GRANT_APPLICATION_NATURAL_REWRITE.md - Use if asked to resubmit full form
3. NEXT_STEPS_GRANT_RESUBMISSION.md - This document (your guide)

Backup: Original files (Arbitrum_Grant_Application_REVISED.md, GRANT_PORTAL_RESPONSES.md) are unchanged for reference.

Contact If Needed

If evaluators ask technical questions you need help with: - Smart contract verification - Detailed AI architecture explanation - Timeboost integration research scope - Budget breakdown justification

Let me know and I can help craft responses.

Good luck!